

VARIEGATES & FRUITS FOR ICE CREAMS

ROASTED CHERRIES

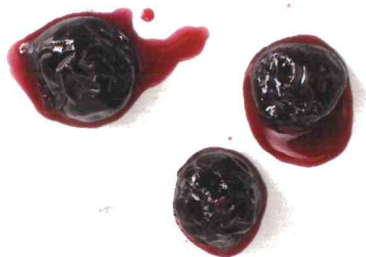
Roasting cherries concentrates the flavors and natural fruit sugars. Roasted cherries are great for putting in ice cream, for adding on top of it while serving, or even in a pie à la mode sundae (see page 50).

Makes about 1¼ cups

2 cups pitted fresh or frozen (not thawed) red or black cherries
¾ cup sugar
2 teaspoons cornstarch

Preheat the oven to 400°F.

Combine the cherries, sugar, and cornstarch in a 9-inch square baking dish, tossing to mix. Roast for 30 to 45 minutes, until the juices are thickened and bubbly, stirring every 15 minutes. Let cool completely, then chill in the refrigerator.



BRANDIED CHERRIES

Great atop any of our sundaes. Or serve the cherries as a sauce.

Makes 3½ cups

1 pound fresh black cherries, pitted, or frozen black cherries

¼ cup sugar

¼ cup brandy

Combine the cherries, sugar, and brandy in a medium saucepan and bring to a boil, stirring to dissolve the sugar. Boil for 5 minutes, then remove from the heat and let cool. Refrigerate, overnight if possible, before serving.



about 8 minutes. Remove from the heat and let cool, then refrigerate until cold before using.

RASPBERRY, BLACK RASPBERRY, OR BLACKBERRY SAUCE

This sauce will not freeze fully when it's frozen, so it's perfect to swirl through any ice cream.

Makes about 1¼ cups

2 cups raspberries, black raspberries, and/or blackberries

1 cup sugar

Combine the berries and sugar in a small saucepan and bring to a boil over medium-high heat. Continue boiling, stirring occasionally, until it reaches 220°F (5 to 8 minutes). Let cool slightly, then force through a sieve to remove the seeds. (Or leave a few seeds in there just to prove you made it.) Refrigerate until cold before using.

BLUEBERRY SAUCE

Fabulous with citrus yogurts or in sundaes, this sauce is versatile, easy, and gorgeous.

Makes about 1¾ cups

1½ cups blueberries

¾ cup sugar

Mix the blueberries and sugar in a small saucepan and bring to a boil over medium heat. Reduce the heat and simmer, stirring occasionally, until the berries are tender and the sauce is thickened,